1) Lesson 9/10/26

1.1) Inequalities

General Procedure:

1. Determine the domain D.
2. Bring all terms to one side: $f(x) \gtrless 0$.
3. Factor into products or fractions: $\frac{A(x)}{B(x)} \gtrless 0$.
    1. Find the roots of each factor.
    2. Construct a sign chart.
4. Intersect the resulting intervals with the domain D.

There can happen 3 main cases: fractions, square roots or absolute values

Ex c) Fraction

Solve the following inequality:

$$\frac{x-1}{x-2} > \frac{2x-3}{x-3}$$

Domain:

$$D = x \in \mathbb{R} \setminus \{2, 3\}$$

Simplify:

$$\frac{x-1}{x-2} - \frac{2x-3}{x-3} > 0 \implies \frac{(x-1)(x-3) - (2x-3)(x-2)}{(x-2)(x-3)} > 0$$

This is of form $A(x)/B(x)$ so the study of the numerator and denominator needs to be done independently

Numerator:
Find zeroes:

$$\begin{aligned}(x-1)(x-3) - (2x-3)(x-2) &= (x^2 - 4x + 3) - (2x^2 - 7x + 6) \\ &= -x^2 + 3x - 3\end{aligned}$$

Recall the quadratic formula:
Let $a, b, c \in \mathbb{R}$, then $ax^2 + bx + c = 0$ has the following solution:

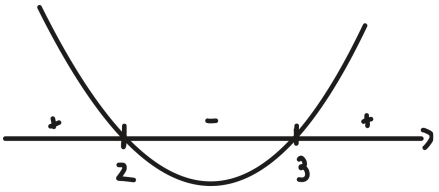
$$x_{1,2} = \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}}{2a}$$

Where the discriminant $\Delta = b^2 - 4ac$ determines the types of solution:

- $\Delta > 0$: two real (distinct) solutions
- $\Delta = 0$: two real (identical) solutions
- $\Delta < 0$: no real solution

In this case since $\Delta = 9 - 12 = -3 < 0$ we don't have any solutions, hence since $a < 0$ the whole numerator is negative.

Denominator:
Here the function already shows the zeroes, so we can plot the graph to see the regions:



Curve

So we have positive denominator for $x < 2 \cup x > 3$.

By noticing the interval where they have the same sign:

x	$(-\infty, 2)$	$(2, 3)$	$(3, +\infty)$
Numerator	$-$	$-$	$-$
Denominator	$+$	$-$	$+$
Fraction	$-$	$+$	$-$

Finally we have:

$$\boxed{2 < x < 3}$$

Ex d) Absolute value

Solve the following inequality:

$$\frac{|x|}{x-1} > \frac{x+1}{2x-1}$$

Domain:

$$D = x \in \mathbb{R} \setminus \left\{ \frac{1}{2}, 1 \right\}$$

Now recall the abs value definition:

$$|f(x)| = \begin{cases} f(x) & f(x) \geq 0 \\ -f(x) & f(x) < 0 \end{cases}$$

In this case $f(x) = x$ so we have:

$$\begin{cases} \dfrac{x}{x-1} > \dfrac{x+1}{2x-1} & x \geq 0 \\ \dfrac{-x}{x-1} > \dfrac{x+1}{2x-1} & x < 0 \end{cases}$$

Remeber:

- The solution to each part of the system must be put in intersection with the condition
- The solutions of the parts of a system are in union with each other

Start with case 1:
Rewrite so that it is a single fraction:

$$\frac{x}{x-1} - \frac{x+1}{2x-1} > 0 \implies \frac{x(2x-1) - (x+1)(x-1)}{(x-1)(2x-1)} > 0$$

- Numerator:

$$x(2x-1)-(x^2-1)=2x^2-x-x^2+1=x^2-x+1$$

Find the zeroes of the numerator:

$$x^2-x+1=0 \to \Delta=-3$$

Since $\Delta<0$ and $a=1>0$, the numerator is strictly positive.

- Denominator:

$$(x-1)(2x-1)>0 \iff x<\frac{1}{2} \cup x>1$$

Sign analysis for Case 1:

x	$\left(-\infty,\frac{1}{2}\right)$	$\left(\frac{1}{2},1\right)$	$(1,+\infty)$
Numerator	$+$	$+$	$+$
Denominator	$+$	$-$	$+$
Fraction	$+$	$-$	$+$

So the fraction is >0 on $\left(-\infty,\frac{1}{2}\right)\cup(1,+\infty)$.

Intersecting with the case condition $x\geq 0$:

$$S_1=\left[0,\frac{1}{2}\right)\cup(1,+\infty)$$

Case 2:
Same procedure as case 1:

$$\frac{-x}{x-1}-\frac{x+1}{2x-1}>0 \implies \frac{-x(2x-1)-(x+1)(x-1)}{(x-1)(2x-1)}>0$$

- Numerator:

$$-2x^2+x-(x^2-1)=-3x^2+x+1$$

Find the zeroes of the numerator:

$$x_{1,2}=\frac{-1\pm\sqrt{13}}{-6}=\frac{1\mp\sqrt{13}}{6}$$

Since $a=-3<0$, the parabola opens downward:

$$N>0 \iff x_1=\frac{1-\sqrt{13}}{6}<x<\frac{1+\sqrt{13}}{6}=x_2$$

Denominator:
The denominator roots are $\frac{1}{2}=0.5$ and 1.

Sign analysis for the factors:

x	$(-\infty,x_1)$	$(x_1,1/2)$	$(1/2,x_2)$	$(x_2,1)$	$(1,+\infty)$
Numerator	$-$	$+$	$+$	$-$	$-$
Denominator	$+$	$+$	$-$	$-$	$+$
Fraction	$-$	$+$	$-$	$+$	$-$

The fraction is > 0 on $\left(x_1, \frac{1}{2}\right) \cup (x_2, 1)$.

Intersecting with the case condition $x < 0$:

$$S_2 = \left(\frac{1-\sqrt{13}}{6}, 0\right)$$

Taking the union of both cases $S = S_1 \cup S_2$:

$$S = \left(\frac{1-\sqrt{13}}{6}, 0\right) \cup \left[0, \frac{1}{2}\right) \cup (1, +\infty)$$

Notice that 0 is included in the solution set, so the first two intervals join together:

$$\boxed{S = \left(\frac{1-\sqrt{13}}{6}, \frac{1}{2}\right) \cup (1, +\infty)}$$

Ex f) Square Root

Solve the following inequality:

$$\sqrt{x^2 - 6x} > x + 2$$

First notice that the domain is

$$x^2 - 6x \geq 0 \rightarrow D = (-\infty, 0] \cup [6, +\infty)$$

First notice that when $x + 2 < 0$ the solution inequality holds (in the domain). So one part of the solution is:

$$S_1 = D \cap \{x < -2\} = \{x < -2\}$$

Now for $x + 2 \geq 0$ of both sides can be squared:

$$x^2 - 6x > x^2 + 4x + 4 \rightarrow 0 > 10x + 4 \rightarrow x < -\frac{2}{5}$$

This clearly for the values bigger than -2 in the domain, that is

$$S_2 = D \cap \left\{\{x \geq -2\} \cap \left\{x < -\frac{2}{5}\right\}\right\} = D \cap \left\{-2 \leq x < -\frac{2}{5}\right\} = \left\{-2 \leq x < -\frac{2}{5}\right\}$$

So the result is:

$$S = S_1 \cup S_2 = \{x < -2\} \cup \left\{-2 \leq x < -\frac{2}{5}\right\} = x < -\frac{2}{5}$$

Ex i) Mixed Together

Solve the following inequality:

$$\sqrt{|x^2 - 4|} - x \geq 0$$

Domain: $|x^2 - 4| \geq 0 \rightarrow D = \mathbb{R}$

Now recall the abs value definition:

$$|f(x)| = \begin{cases} f(x) & f(x) \geq 0 \\ -f(x) & f(x) < 0 \end{cases}$$

In this case $f(x) = x^2 - 4 = (x+2)(x-2)$ so $f(x) \geq 0 \rightarrow x \leq -2 \cup x \geq 2$

Now we can rewrite the inequality as a system of two inequalities:

$$\sqrt{|x^2-4|} - x \geq 0 \rightarrow \begin{cases} \sqrt{x^2-4} - x \geq 0 & x \leq -2 \cup x \geq 2 \\ \sqrt{4-x^2} - x \geq 0 & -2 < x < 2 \end{cases}$$

Each system can be solved independently from the other.
Call the conditions of the cases D_1 and D_2 respectively.

Solve first case:
Recall that when RHS (x) is negative there is always a solution.

$$\sqrt{x^2-4} \geq x$$

Therefore one part of the solution includes $x < 0$

Now study in the interval $x \geq 0$: since we are sure that both sides are ≥ 0 we can square both sides:

$$x^2 - 4 \geq x^2 \rightarrow -4 \geq 0$$

Not possible, so the only solution to this part is when x is negative:

$$S_1 = x \leq 0 \cap D_1 = x \leq -2$$

Solve the second equation:
As before a solution always exists for $x < 0$. Now consider only the positive values ($x \geq 0$) in order to be able to square both sides:

$$\sqrt{4-x^2} \geq x \rightarrow 4 - x^2 \geq x^2 \rightarrow 4 - 2x^2 \geq 0 \rightarrow -\sqrt{2} \leq x \leq \sqrt{2}$$

So we have $S_2 = D_2 \cap \left\{ x < 0 \cup -\sqrt{2} \leq x \leq \sqrt{2} \right\} = D_2 \cap x \leq \sqrt{2} = -2 < x \leq \sqrt{2}$

The result is therefore the union of both cases which yields:

$$\boxed{S = x \leq -2 \cup -2 < x \leq \sqrt{2} \rightarrow S = x \leq \sqrt{2}}$$

1.2) Subsets of $\mathbb{R}$

Ex a)

Describe the following set:

$$A = S_1 \cap S_2 = \left\{ x \in \mathbb{R} : x^2 + 4x + 13 < 0 \right\} \cap \left\{ x \in \mathbb{R} : 3x^2 + 5 > 0 \right\}$$

Subset 1:

$$x^2 + 4x + 13 < 0 \rightarrow \Delta = -36 \implies S_1 = \emptyset$$

any intersection with an empty set is an empty set:

$$\boxed{A = \emptyset \ \cap \ S_2 = \emptyset}$$

In general recall:

$$\emptyset \cap S = \emptyset \qquad \emptyset \cup S = S$$

Ex c)

Describe the following set:

$$C = \left\{ x \in \mathbb{R} : \frac{x^2 - 5x + 4}{x^2 - 9} < 0 \right\} \cup \left\{ x \in \mathbb{R} : x + \sqrt{7x + 1} = 17 \right\}$$

Subset 1:
First notice that the domain is $x \neq \pm 3$

Numerator:

$$x^2 - 5x + 4 = 0 \to x_{1,2} = 1,\ 4 \to N > 0 \iff x < 1 \cup x > 4$$

Denominator:

$$x^2 - 9 = (x + 3)(x - 3) = 0 \to D > 0 \iff x < -3 \cup x > 3$$

x	$(-\infty, -3)$	$(-3, 1)$	$(1, 3)$	$(3, 4)$	$(4, +\infty)$
Numerator	$+$	$+$	$-$	$-$	$+$
Denominator	$+$	$-$	$-$	$+$	$+$
Fraction	$+$	$-$	$+$	$-$	$+$

so $S_1 = (-3, 1) \cup (3, 4)$

Subset 2:
This is just an equality:

$$\sqrt{7x + 1} = 17 - x$$

The domain is $7x + 1 \geq 0 \to D = \left\{ x \geq -\frac{1}{7} \right\}$
Moreover as before, both sides must have the same sign when squaring and since the sqrt is always ≥ 0 we must have that also $17 - x \geq 0 \to x \leq 17$ so we can further reduce the domain to

$$D = \left[-\frac{1}{7}, 17 \right]$$

Square both sides:

$$7x + 1 = (17 - x)^2 \to 7x + 1 = x^2 - 34x + 17^2 \to x^2 - 41x + 288 = 0$$

$$x_{1,2} = 9,\ 32$$

But only 9 is acceptable as $32 \notin D$

Finally:

$$\boxed{C = (-3, 1) \cup (3, 4) \cup \{9\}}$$

1.3) Max/Min, Sup/Inf

Recall the theory

Definition (Upper/Lower Bound)**.**

$M \in \mathbb{Q}$ is called **upper bound** for A if $M \geq a, \forall a \in A$.

Respectively it is called **lower bound** if $M \leq a, \forall a \in A$

Notice M does not need to be in A
Example: consider set $A = [0, 1)$ any $m \leq 0$ is a lower bound and any $M \geq 1$ is upper bound

Definition (Maximum/Minimum of A)**.**

If $\overline{M}$ is an upper bound for A and $\overline{M} \in A$, then $\overline{M}$ is the *minimum* possible *upper* bound and is the **maximum** (of A).

If $\overline{m}$ is an lower bound for A and $\overline{m} \in A$, then $\overline{m}$ is the *maximum* possible *lower* bound and the **minimum** (of A).

In this case $\overline{M} \in A$ by definition.
From the previous example: $\overline{m} = \max\{m \leq 0\} = 0 \in A$ is the correct minimum of A, however $\overline{M} = \min\{M \geq 1\} = 1 \notin A$ means that we don't have a maximum

Definition (Supremum/Infimum)**.**

The **supremum of** A $\sup A$ is the minimum of the upper bounds of A.

The **infimum of** A $\inf A$ is the maximum of the lower bounds of A.

Finish the example: we know $\overline{m} = 0 \in A$ so this is both minimum and infimum of A. We know also $\overline{M} = 1 \notin A$, therefore $\sup \mathrm{A} = 1$ but it is not the maximum.

Recall that if a set is unbounded, then

$$\sup A = +\infty \quad \text{if } A \text{ is unbounded from above}$$
$$\inf A = -\infty \quad \text{if } A \text{ is unbounded from below}$$

Ex a)

Tell wether this subsets is bounded and the sup/inf and if it allow for maximum/minimum.

$$A = \left\{ x \in \mathbb{R} : x = n \text{ or } x = \frac{1}{n^2}, n \in N \setminus \{0\} \right\}$$

It is immediately clear that A is the union of two sets, mainly

$$A = S_1 \cup S_2 \text{ where } \begin{array}{l} S_1 = \{n \in \mathbb{N} \setminus \{0\}\} = \{1, 2, 3, 4, \ldots\} \\ S_2 = \left\{ \frac{1}{n^2} \mid n \in \mathbb{N} \setminus \{0\} \right\} = \left\{ 1, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{9}, \frac{1}{16}, \ldots \right\} \end{array}$$

Find the bounds on both sets individually (not required but the result is clearer).

Study the first subset S_1: notice that it is just the natural numbers with zero excluded, so its properties are already known.

- No upper bound, so also no max
  - Supremum: since unbounded; $\sup S_1 = +\infty$
- Lower bound: $m_1 \leq 1$
  - Minimum: $\overline{m}_1 = \max m_1 \leq 1 = 1 \in S$

Study the second subset S_2: Intuitively we know that the function describing the set is monotonically decreasing: we can express it by saying:

Call x_n the value of x for any chosen n, then $x_{n+1} < x_n$.
This is easily shown as the following inequality is true for $n \in \mathbb{N} \setminus \{0\}$ (check at home):

$$\frac{1}{(n+1)^2} < \frac{1}{n^2}$$

Therefore for every number $x_n > 0$ we can find a smaller number such that $0 < x_{n+1} < x_n$

Is 0 the maximum lower bound?
By contradiction suppose there exists a lower bound $\delta > 0$ then if 0 is the maximum lower bound we have

$$\exists n \in \mathbb{N} \setminus \{0\} \quad \text{such that} \quad \frac{1}{n^2} < \delta$$

Now compute

$$\frac{1}{n^2} < \delta \to n^2 > \frac{1}{\delta} \to n > \frac{1}{\sqrt{\delta}}$$

Because $\delta > 0$, the number $\frac{1}{\sqrt{\delta}}$ is just a fixed positive real number and an appropriate n exists.

With this digression aside, we also know that $0 \notin S_2$.
As before analyze:

- Lower bound: $m_2 \leq 0$
  - No minimum: $\overline{m}_2 = \max m_2 \leq 0 = 0 \notin S_2$
  - Infimum is $\inf S_2 = 0$
- Upper bound: $M_2 \geq 1$
  - $\overline{M}_2 = \min M_2 \geq 1 = 1 \in S_2$

Putting all together:
Now consider the union, so:

- No upper bound since S_1 is unbounded
  - therefore $\sup A = +\infty$
- Lower bound: The infimum is the **maximum** of all lower bounds: $\inf A = \min(\inf S_1, \inf S_2) = \min(1, 0) = 0$. Since $0 \notin A$, $\min A$ does not exist.

2) Lesson 16/10/26

2.1) Domains

Recall:

$$f(x) = \begin{matrix} \dfrac{a(x)}{g(x)} & \text{dom } f = \{g(x) \neq 0\} \\ \sqrt{g(x)} & \text{dom } f = \{g(x) \geq 0\} \\ \log(g(x)) & \text{dom } f = \{g(x) > 0\} \end{matrix}$$

a) Fraction and Sqrt

Determine the domains of the following function:

$$f(x) = \frac{\sqrt{x^2 - 3x - 4}}{x + 5}$$

Here the domain is given by two solutions that must hold simultaneously.

Fraction:
Here $D_1 = \{x + 5 \neq 0\} = \{x \neq -5\}$

Sqrt:
Here $D_2 = \{x^2 - 3x - 4 \geq 0\}$. The zeroes of this function are $x_{1,2} = -1, 4$ so the inequality holds for $D_2 = \{x \leq -1 \cup x \geq 4\}$

Finally

$$\text{dom } f = D_1 \cap D_2 = \{x \leq -1 \cup x \geq 4\} \setminus \{-5\} = (-\infty, -5) \cup (-5, -1] \cup [4, +\infty)$$

where the last part is the correct formal way to write the result.

b) Logarithm

Determine the domains of the following function:

$$f(x) = \log(x^2 - x)$$

The domain is given by $x^2 - x > 0$, so solve the inequality:

$$x^2 - x = x(x - 1) > 0$$

The first term is positive for $x > 0$, the second for $x > 1$, so

$$\text{dom } f = \{x < 0 \cup x > 1\}$$

c) System

Determine the domains of the following function:

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \dfrac{1}{2x + 1} & x \geq 0 \\ e^{\sqrt{x+1}} & x < 0 \end{cases}$$

Here the domain is given by the union of the two cases.

Case 1:
Here the domain is given by $D_1^* = \{2x + 1 \neq 0\} = \left\{x \neq -\frac{1}{2}\right\}$. However since this is a system, this must hold only inside the specified case, so $D_1 = D_1^* \cap \{x \geq 0\} = \{x \geq 0\}$ since $-\frac{1}{2} \notin \{x \geq 0\}$, so this part of the map is always valid.

Case 2:
Here the domain is given by $x + 1 \geq 0 \rightarrow x \geq -1$ which combined with the system is $x \in [-1, 0)$

The final domain becomes the union of the two cases, so

$$\text{dom } f = \{x \geq 0\} \cup \{-1 \leq x < 0\} = \{x \geq -1\}$$

2.2) Symmetries and Periodicity

If a function is symmetric, it can have either even or odd symmetry:

- Even Symmetry: mirrored along y axis: $f(x) = f(-x)$
- Odd Symmetry: mirrored along x and y axis: $f(x) = -f(-x)$

a) Sqrt and Abs

Sketch the graph of the following function indicating the possible symmetries and/or periodicity:

$$f(x) = \sqrt{1 - |x|}$$

Domain:

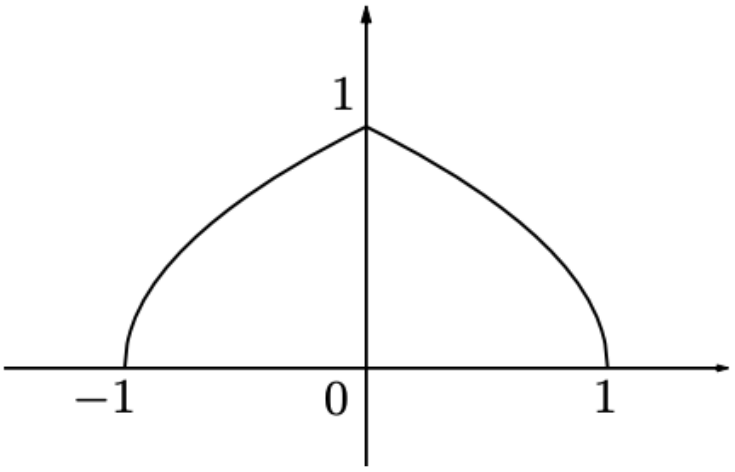
$$D = \{1 - |x| \geq 0\} = \{|x| \leq 1\} = \{x \in [-1, 1]\}$$

So clearly the function cannot be periodic. By definition, a periodic function requires $x \in \text{dom } f \implies x + T \in \text{dom } f$ for all x, which cannot hold on a bounded interval

Symmetry:
Since f is the result of a sqrt, it can only be non negative (roots at $x = \pm 1$), therefore an odd symmetry is not possible (only possible if f is constant 0). Try the even symmetry:

$$f(-x) = \sqrt{1 - |-x|} = \sqrt{1 - |-1| \cdot |x|} = \sqrt{1 - 1 \cdot |x|} = f(x)$$

The final sketch can be done by sampling points only between $[0, 1]$ since then it can be mirrored.



Sketch

b) Cosine

Sketch the graph of the following function indicating the possible symmetries and/or periodicity:

$$f(x) = 1 + \cos(2x)$$

There is no restriction in the domain, so start with the symmetries. Again since $\cos(z) \in [-1, 1]$ the function returns only non-negative values, so an odd symmetry is excluded, moreover since $\cos(z)$ is an even function, we can guess that the function is even, let's prove it:

$$f(-x) = 1 + \cos(-2x) = 1 + \cos(2x) = f(x)$$

Periodicity:
T_1: 1 is a constant function. A constant function $c(x) = c$ satisfies $c(x+T) = c(x)$ for **every** $T > 0$. Therefore, every positive real number is a period. However it does not have a fundamental period (0 cannot be period)
T_2: $\cos(\theta)$ has period 2π, that is $\cos(\theta + 2\pi) = \cos(\theta)$, but what about $g(x) = \cos(2x)$? Let's try the generic case $\cos(ax)$, $a > 0$

By the definition of period, we must find a $T > 0$ such that

$$\min_T \{T > 0 : g(x+T) = g(x)\ \forall x \in \mathbb{R}\} = \min_T \{\cos(a(x+T)) = \cos(ax)\}$$

Recall that $\cos(\theta + 2\pi) = \cos(\theta)$ and by comparing it with the argument of the minimum we get

$$aT = 2\pi \to T = \frac{2\pi}{a}$$

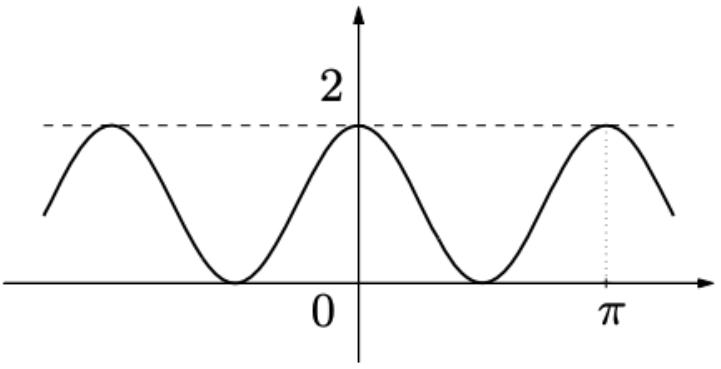
And in our case $T_2 = \pi$

Adding a constant is merely a vertical translation and leaves the periodic properties unchanged:

$$f(x+T) = f(x) \iff 1 + \cos(2(x+T)) = 1 + \cos(2x) \iff \cos(2(x+T)) = \cos(2x)$$

Therefore, the fundamental period of $f(x)$ is simply the fundamental period of $\cos(2x)$:

$$T = \frac{2\pi}{2} = \pi$$



Sketch

Two sinusoids

Determine the period of the following function:

$$f(x) = \sin(2x) + \cos(\pi x)$$

From the previous exercise we know that a sinusoidal has period

$$T = \frac{2\pi}{a}$$

So we know the two periods:

$$T_1 = \frac{2\pi}{2} = \pi \qquad T_2 = \frac{2\pi}{\pi} = 2$$

Now for the final period, recall that **the sum of two periodic functions is periodic if and only if the ratio of their periods is a rational number.**
Check the ratio:

$$\frac{T_1}{T_2} = \frac{\pi}{2} \notin \mathbb{Q}$$

so the function is aperiodic.

Now consider

$$f(x) = \sin(2x) + \cos(3x)$$

therefore

$$\begin{aligned} T_1 &= \pi \\ T_2 &= \frac{2\pi}{3} \end{aligned} \qquad \frac{T_1}{T_2} = \frac{3}{2} \in \mathbb{Q}$$

We know the function is periodic! But how is the period found?
To find the fundamental period T, any common period must satisfy $f(x+T) = f(x)$ for all x. For the sum of two independent sinusoids, this requires T to be a simultaneous integer multiple of both individual periods T_1 and T_2:

$$T = k_1 T_1 = k_2 T_2 \quad \text{for some } k_1, k_2 \in \mathbb{Z}^+$$

That is:

$$k_1\pi = k_2\left(\frac{2\pi}{3}\right) \implies k_1 = \frac{2}{3}k_2 \implies \frac{k_1}{k_2} = \frac{2}{3} \qquad k_1 = 2, k_2 = 3$$

and thus the period is

$$T = 2\pi = 3 \cdot \frac{2\pi}{3}$$

1) Arcsin

Determine domain, sign and possible symmetries and periodicity of the following function:

$$f(x) = \arcsin\left(\left|x^3 - \frac{1}{2}\right|\right)$$

Properties of $\arcsin(t)$
The sin function is not bijective (surjective but not injective) the map is $\mathbb{R} \to [-1, 1]$. So the arcsin is defined on the restriction in which this function is strictly increasing and bijective, that is

$$\sin\Big|_{[-\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{\pi}{2}]} : \left[-\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{\pi}{2}\right] \longrightarrow [-1, 1] \implies \arcsin : [-1, 1] \longrightarrow \left[-\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{\pi}{2}\right]$$

The domain is therefore

$$\text{dom } \arcsin = [-1, 1]$$

The sign coincides with the sign of the argument.

Domain:
Recall that $\arcsin(t)$ is defined for $t \in [-1, 1]$, so we must impose this as the domain:

$$-1 \leq \left|x^3 - \frac{1}{2}\right| \leq 1$$

Since the absolute value is always non-negative we have

$$\left|x^3 - \frac{1}{2}\right| \leq 1 \to -1 \leq x^3 - \frac{1}{2} \leq 1 \to -\frac{1}{\sqrt[3]{2}} \leq x \leq \sqrt[3]{\frac{3}{2}}$$

So we have

$$\text{dom } f = \left[-\frac{1}{\sqrt[3]{2}}, \sqrt[3]{\frac{3}{2}}\right]$$

Here we can notice that since the domain is not symmetric wrt the origin, the function does not have any symmetries, that is: A function can have symmetry **only if** its domain is symmetric with respect to the origin

$$x \in \operatorname{dom} f \implies -x \in \operatorname{dom} f$$

Moreover, since it has a finite domain it cannot be periodic.

Sign:
In our case since we have only positive values, the function will always be positive

$$\arcsin(t) \in \left[0, \frac{\pi}{2}\right] \implies \arcsin(t) \geq 0$$

The root is at $\left|x^3 - \frac{1}{2}\right| = 0 \to x = \sqrt[3]{\frac{1}{2}}$

3) Exponential

Determine domain, sign and possible symmetries and periodicity of the following function:

$$f(x) = \log(e^{2x} - 4e^x + 4)$$

First we do a substitution, $y \overset{\triangle}{=} e^x$ and therefore

$$f(y) = \log(y^2 - 4y + 4)$$

Domain:
From the log we impose $y^2 - 4y + 4 > 0$
The roots are $y_{1,2} = 2$ which for x becomes:

$$\begin{aligned} 2 &= e^x \\ \log 2 &= \log e^x \\ x &= \log 2 \end{aligned}$$

so the domain is just dom $f = \mathbb{R} \setminus \{\log 2\} = (-\infty, \log 2) \cup (\log 2, +\infty)$
Since domain is not symmetric wrt to origin, we don't have any symmetry.

Sign:
Recall $\log(z) \geq 0 \iff z \geq 1$, so

$$y^2 - 4y + 4 \geq 1 \to y^2 - 4y + 3 \geq 0$$

The roots are $y_{1,2} = 1, 3 \to x_{1,2} = 0, \log 3$
The inequality holds for $x \leq 0 \cup x \geq \log 3$

So $f(x) \geq 0 \iff x \leq 0$ or $x \geq \log 3$
And the roots are at $x = 0,\ x = \log 3$

7) Hyperbolic Cosine

Determine domain, sign and possible symmetries and periodicity of the following function:

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{\cosh(\sin(x))}$$

What is the hyperbolic cosine?

$$\cosh(t) = \frac{e^t + e^{-t}}{2}$$

So this is always defined and is always positive.
This is also an even function:

$$\cosh(-t) = \frac{e^{-t} + e^t}{2} = \cosh(t)$$

Domain:
First define $a = \sin(x) \in [-1, 1]$
The denominator cannot be 0 so

$$\cosh(a) = \frac{e^a + e^{-a}}{2} \neq 0$$

Which is valid $\forall a$ as $e^k > 0 \quad \forall k \in \mathbb{R}$.

So

$$\text{dom } f = \mathbb{R}$$

Sign:
Hyperbolic cosine is always positive so also this function is always positive with no zero

Symmetry:
Cosh is even $\cosh(x) = \cosh(-x)$, sin is odd $\sin(-x) = -\sin(x)$.
Try even:

$$f(-x) = \frac{1}{\cosh(\sin(-x))} = \frac{1}{\cosh(-\sin(x))} = \frac{1}{\cosh(\sin(x))} = f(x)$$

So it is even!

Is it periodic?
As before impose

$$f(x + T) = f(x) \quad \text{for all } x \in \mathbb{R}$$

Substituting

$$\frac{1}{\cosh(\sin(x + T))} = \frac{1}{\cosh(\sin(x))} \to \cosh(\sin(x + T)) = \cosh(\sin(x))$$

Easy way: Try period of $\sin(x)$ (2π):

$$\begin{aligned} \cosh(\sin(x + 2\pi)) &= \cosh(\sin(x)) \\ \cosh(\sin(x)) &= \cosh(\sin(x)) \end{aligned}$$

Harder way:
Since cosh has even symmetry:

$$\cosh(t) = \cosh(-t) \implies \cosh(t) = \cosh(|t|) \quad \forall t \in \mathbb{R}$$

And therefore (prove at home):

$$\cosh(|u|) = \cosh(|v|) \iff |u| = |v|$$

And thus impose:

$$|\sin(x + T)| = |\sin(x)| \quad \forall x \in \mathbb{R}$$

Squaring both sides:

$$\sin^2(x + T) = \sin^2(x)$$

Using the identity $\sin^2(\theta) = \frac{1 - \cos(2\theta)}{2}$:

$$\frac{1 - \cos(2x + 2T)}{2} = \frac{1 - \cos(2x)}{2} \iff \cos(2x + 2T) = \cos(2x) \quad \forall x \in \mathbb{R}$$

Therefore the period is the same as $\cos(2x)$ which is $T = \pi$ and thus 2π is not the fundamental period (it is a period nonetheless).

10)

Determine domain, sign and possible symmetries and periodicity of the following function:

$$f(x) = \frac{\log(\sin(x))}{\sin(x) - 1}$$

Domain:
Denominator forces $\sin(x) \neq 1$ which holds for $x \neq \frac{\pi}{2} + 2k\pi \quad k \in \mathbb{Z}$
The log forces $\sin(x) > 0$ which is true for $x \in (2k\pi, \pi + 2k\pi) \quad k \in \mathbb{Z}$
so the generic k-th interval is $(2k\pi, \frac{\pi}{2} + 2k\pi) \cup (\frac{\pi}{2} + 2k\pi, \pi + 2k\pi)$
The domain is the union of all these intervals:

$$\text{dom } f = \bigcup_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} (2k\pi, \frac{\pi}{2} + 2k\pi) \cup (\frac{\pi}{2} + 2k\pi, \pi + 2k\pi)$$

which is not symmetric wrt the origin and thus there is no symmetry

Sign:
The denominator is always negative since $\max \sin(x) = 1$ and thus $\max \sin(x) - 1 = 0$ (which is excluded by domain)
The numerator is also always negative:

$$\log(\sin(x)) \geq 0 \iff \sin(x) \geq 1 \iff \sin(x) = 1$$

which is excluded from the domain

Therefore this function is always positive

Periodicity:
Notice that the domain itself needs to be
periodic (or to be $\mathbb{R}$). In this case the domain is given by intervals given by $\sin(x)$ and it can be shifted only by $2k\pi$ to hold correctly. Therefore we can directly try with $T = 2\pi$:

$$f(x + 2\pi) = \frac{\log(\sin(x + 2\pi))}{\sin(x + 2\pi) - 1} = \frac{\log(\sin(x))}{\sin(x) - 1} = f(x)$$

3) Lesson 23/10/26

$$\lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{e^{2x}-1-\sin(2x)}{\sinh^2(x)+x^{\frac{9}{2}}}$$

3.1) Limits

Recall the following indeterminate forms:

$$(+\infty)+(-\infty) \tag{1}$$
$$0^{\pm}\cdot(\pm\infty) \tag{2}$$
$$\frac{0^{\pm}}{0^{\pm}} \tag{3}$$
$$\frac{\pm\infty}{\pm\infty} \tag{4}$$

Where D' is the
Limits at infinity are used to find asymptote. This has an equation of form:

$$y=mx+q$$

Two cases happen:

- $\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x)=c\in\mathbb{R} \longrightarrow$ asymptote is $y=c$ $(m=0)$
- $\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x)=\pm\infty \longrightarrow$ here we might have an oblique asymptote $(m\neq 0)$ or a generic divergence. The slope can be found with:

  $$m=\lim_{x\to\pm\infty}\frac{f(x)}{x}$$

  if $m=\pm\infty$ there is no asymptote, otherwise q can be found as

  $$q=\lim f(x)-mx$$

1) Fraction

Determine the natural domain, the sign, and the limits at infinity (if any) and at the accumulation points of the domain.

$$f(x)=\frac{x-5}{x^2-9}$$

Domain:

$$D=x\in\mathbb{R}\setminus\{\pm 3\}$$

Sign:

- Numerator $>0 \longrightarrow x>5$
- Denominator $>0 \longrightarrow x\in(-\infty,-3)\cup(3,+\infty)$

$$f(x)>0 \iff x\in(-3,3)\cup(5,+\infty)$$

Limits at infinity:

- Positive Infinity:

  $$\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x)=\frac{\infty}{\infty} \quad \text{indeterminate form !}$$

  Notice that:

$$f(x) = \frac{x(1-\frac{5}{x})}{x^2(1-\frac{9}{x^2})} = \frac{(1-\frac{5}{x})}{x(1-\frac{9}{x^2})}$$

The fractional terms tend to zero ($\lim_{x\to\infty} c/x^n = 0$) so

$$\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x) = \lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{(1-\frac{5}{x})}{x(1-\frac{9}{x^2})} = \frac{1-0^+}{\infty(1-0^+)} = \frac{1^-}{\infty} = 0^+$$

- Negative Infinity:

$$\lim_{x\to-\infty} f(x) = \frac{1-0^-}{-\infty(1-0^-)} = \frac{1^+}{-\infty} = 0^-$$

Limits at accumulation points:
Here the use of the sign will be useful to determine if we have 0^+ or 0^- at the denominator

- At $+3$:

$$\lim_{x\to3^+} f(x) = \frac{-2}{0^+} = -\infty$$

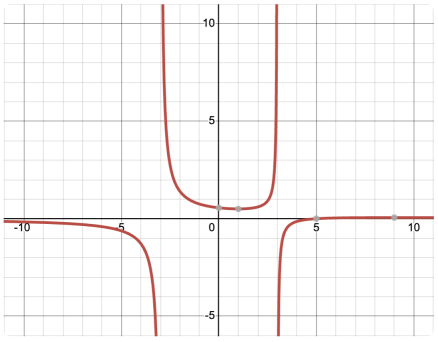
check also 3^-:

$$\lim_{x\to3^-} f(x) = \frac{-2}{0^-} = +\infty \neq \lim_{x\to3^+} f(x)$$

So the limit doesn't exist.

- At -3:

$$\lim_{x\to-3^+} f(x) = \frac{-8}{0^-} = +\infty \neq \lim_{x\to-3^-} f(x) = \frac{-8}{0^+} = -\infty$$



Graph

2) Oblique Asymptote

Determine the natural domain, the sign, and the limits at infinity (if any) and at the accumulation points of the domain.

$$f(x) = \frac{x^3}{x^2-1}$$

Domain:

$$D = x \in \mathbb{R} \setminus \{\pm1\}$$

Sign:

- Numerator $> 0 \longrightarrow x > 0$
- Denominator $> 0 \longrightarrow x \in (-\infty,-1) \cup (1,+\infty)$

$$f(x) > 0 \iff x \in (-1,0) \cup (1,+\infty)$$

Limits at infinity:

- Positive Infinity:

$$\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x) = \frac{\infty}{\infty} \quad \text{indeterminate form !}$$

Notice that:

$$f(x) = \frac{x^3}{x^2(1-\frac{1}{x^2})} = \frac{x}{1-\frac{1}{x^2}}$$

The fractional terms tend to zero ($\lim_{x\to\infty} c/x^n = 0$) so

$$\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x) = \lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{x}{1-\frac{1}{x^2}} = \frac{\infty}{1-0^+} = \infty$$

Is there an oblique asymptote?

$$m = \lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{f(x)}{x} = \lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{1}{1-\frac{1}{x^2}} = 1$$
$$q = \lim_{x\to\infty} f(x) - x = \lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{1}{x(1-\frac{1}{x^2})} = 0^+$$

- Negative Infinity:

$$\lim_{x\to-\infty} f(x) = \lim_{x\to-\infty} \frac{x}{1-\frac{1}{x^2}} = \frac{\infty}{1-0^+} = -\infty$$

Is there an oblique asymptote?

$$m = \lim_{x\to-\infty} \frac{f(x)}{x} = \lim_{x\to-\infty} \frac{1}{1-\frac{1}{x^2}} = 1$$
$$q = \lim_{x\to-\infty} f(x) - x = \lim_{x\to-\infty} \frac{1}{x(1-\frac{1}{x^2})} = 0^-$$

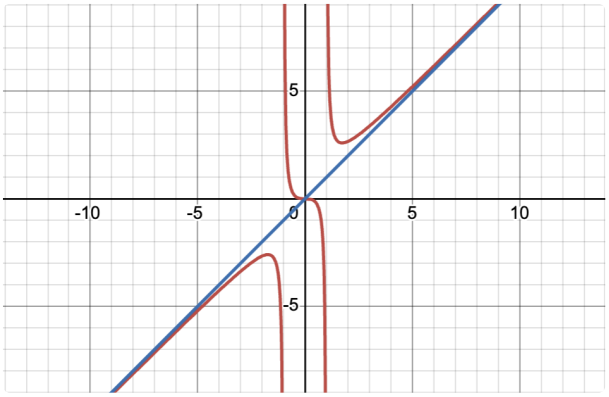
Limits at accumulation points:

- At $+1$:

$$\lim_{x\to1^+} f(x) = \frac{1}{0^+} = \infty \neq \lim_{x\to1^-} f(x) = \frac{1}{0^-} = -\infty$$

- At -1:

$$\lim_{x\to-1^+} f(x) = \frac{-1}{0^-} = +\infty \neq \lim_{x\to-1^-} f(x) = \frac{-1}{0^+} = -\infty$$



Asymptote in Blue

4) Log

Determine the natural domain, the sign, and the limits at infinity (if any) and at the accumulation points of the domain.

$$f(x) = \log\left(\frac{x+1}{x-1}\right)$$

Domain:

$$D = \left\{\frac{x+1}{x-1} > 0\right\} \cap \{x \neq 1\} = (-\infty, -1) \cup (1, +\infty)$$

Sign:

$$f(x) > 0 \iff \frac{x+1}{x-1} > 1 \to x > 1$$

We don't have any zero.

Limits at infinity:

- Positive Infinity:

  $$\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x) = \log\left(\frac{\infty}{\infty}\right) \quad \text{indeterminate form!}$$

  Notice that $\frac{x+1}{x-1} = \frac{x(1+1/x)}{x(1-1/x)} = \frac{1+\frac{1}{x}}{1-\frac{1}{x}}$ so

  $$\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x) = \log(1^+) = 0^+$$

  where we know that the solution must be positive from the domain.
  In general recall that a ratio of polynomial can be solved by just looking at the max degree of numerator and denominator!
- Negative Infinity:

  $$\lim_{x\to-\infty} f(x) = \log\left(1^-\right) = 0^-$$

  sign is deduced from previous sign analysis!

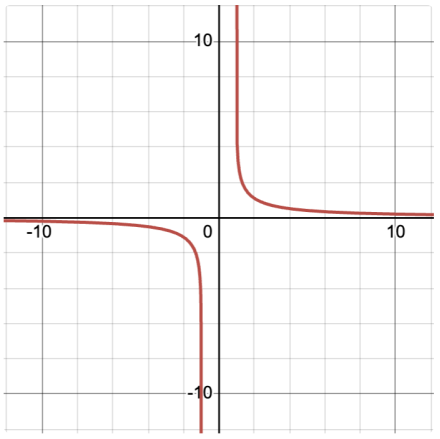
Limits at accumulation points:

- At 1 (only 1^+ due to domain):

  $$\lim_{x\to 1^+} f(x) = \log\left(\frac{2}{0^+}\right) = \log(+\infty) = \infty$$

- At -1 (only -1^- due to domain):

  $$\lim_{x\to -1^-} f(x) = \log\left(\frac{0^-}{-2}\right) = \log(0^+) = -\infty$$



Graph

7) Log o Log

Determine the natural domain, the sign, and the limits at infinity (if any) and at the accumulation points of the domain.

$$f(x) = \frac{\log(\log(x))}{1+\log(x)}$$

Domain:
We have three conditions:

- Inner logarithm requires: $x > 0$
- Outer logarithm in the numerator requires: $\log(x) > 0 \implies x > 1$
- Denominator must not vanish: $1 + \log(x) \neq 0 \implies \log(x) \neq -1 \implies x \neq \frac{1}{e}$
  Since $\frac{1}{e} \approx 0.37 < 1$, the condition $x \neq \frac{1}{e}$ is automatically satisfied for $x > 1$.

$$D = (1, +\infty)$$

Sign:

- Denominator: For all $x \in D = (1, +\infty)$, $\log(x) > 0$, so $1 + \log(x) > 1 > 0$ (always positive).
- Numerator:

$$\log(\log(x)) > 0 \iff \log(x) > 1 \iff x > e$$

$$f(x) > 0 \iff x \in (e, +\infty)$$

Limits at infinity:

- Positive Infinity:

$$\lim_{x \to +\infty} f(x) = \frac{+\infty}{+\infty} \quad \text{indeterminate form!}$$

  Substitute $t = \log(x)$.
  As $x \to +\infty$, $t \to +\infty$:

$$\lim_{t \to +\infty} \frac{\log(t)}{1+t} = \lim_{t \to +\infty} \frac{\log(t)}{t\left(1+\frac{1}{t}\right)} = \lim_{t \to +\infty} \frac{\log(t)}{t} \cdot \frac{1}{1+\frac{1}{t}}$$

  Recall the hierarchy of infinities ($\lim_{t \to +\infty} \frac{\log(t)}{t} = 0^+$):

$$\lim_{x \to +\infty} f(x) = 0^+ \cdot 1 = 0^+$$

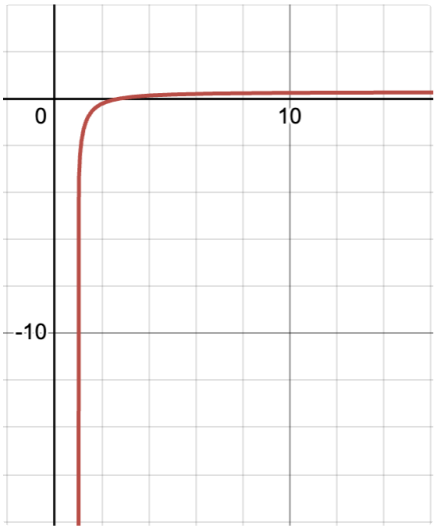
- Negative Infinity: Excluded by domain.

Limits at accumulation points:

- At 1 (only 1^+ due to domain):
  Numerator: as $x \to 1^+$, $\log(x) \to 0^+ \implies \log(\log(x)) \to -\infty$
  Denominator: $1 + \log(1^+) = 1 + 0^+ = 1^+$

$$\lim_{x \to 1^+} f(x) = \frac{-\infty}{1^+} = -\infty$$

  The line $x = 1$ is a vertical asymptote from the right.



Graph

8) Limited

Determine the natural domain, the sign, and the limits at infinity (if any) and at the accumulation points of the domain.

$$f(x) = \frac{\sqrt{1+x} - \sqrt{1-x}}{x}$$

Domain:

$$D = \{1 + x \geq 0\} \cap \{1 - x \geq 0\} \cap \{x \neq 0\} = [-1, 0) \cup (0, 1] = [-1, 1] \setminus \{0\}$$

Sign:
Two alternatives:

1. Find numerator denominator as usual (do at home):
   Numerator $> 0 \iff x \in (0, 1]$
   Denominator $> 0 \iff x > 0$
   so $f(x) > 0 \forall x \in D$
2. Rationalize

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) &= \frac{(\sqrt{1+x} - \sqrt{1-x})(\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x})}{x(\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x})} \\ &= \frac{(1+x) - (1-x)}{x(\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x})} \\ &= \frac{2x}{x(\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x})} \\ &= \frac{2}{\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{1-x}} \quad (\text{ only since } D \text{ excludes } 0) \end{aligned}$$

Since $\sqrt{1+x}+\sqrt{1-x}>0$ for all $x \in [-1,1]$:

$$f(x) > 0 \quad \forall x \in D$$

We don't have any zeros.

Limits at infinity:
Positive and Negative Infinity are excluded by domain ($D \subset [-1,1]$, so $\pm\infty$ are not accumulation points of D).
There are no horizontal or oblique asymptotes.

Limits at accumulation points:

- At 0:

$$\lim_{x\to 0} f(x) = \frac{0}{0} \quad \text{indeterminate form!}$$

Using the rationalized form:

$$\lim_{x\to 0} f(x) = \lim_{x\to 0} \frac{2}{\sqrt{1+x}+\sqrt{1-x}} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{1}+\sqrt{1}} = \frac{2}{2} = 1$$

Notice that:

$$\lim_{x\to 0^+} f(x) = \lim_{x\to 0^-} f(x) = 1$$

So the two-sided limit exists! $x=0$ is a removable discontinuity (eliminable singularity).

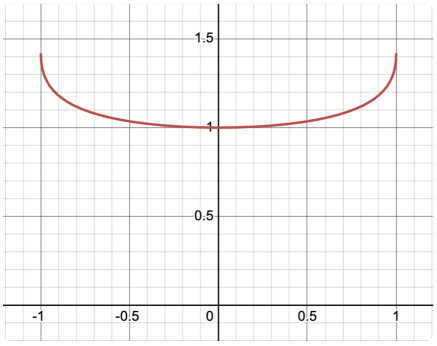
- At $+1$ (only 1^- due to domain): Since $1 \in D$, the function is continuous from the left:

$$\lim_{x\to 1^-} f(x) = f(1) = \frac{\sqrt{2}-0}{1} = \sqrt{2}$$

- At -1 (only $(-1)^+$ due to domain):Since $-1 \in D$, the function is continuous from the right:

$$\lim_{x\to -1^+} f(x) = f(-1) = \frac{0-\sqrt{2}}{-1} = \sqrt{2}$$

There are no vertical asymptotes.



Graph

4) Lesson 26/10/26

4.1) Standard Limits Exercises

3) Two Policemen (Harder!)

Determine the natural domain, the sign, and the limits at infinity (if any) and at the accumulation points of the domain.

$$f(x) = \log(e^{2x} - 1)$$

Domain:

$$D = \{e^{2x} - 1 > 0\} = \{x > 0\}$$

Sign:

$$f(x) > 0 \iff e^{2x} - 1 > 1 \to x > \frac{\log 2}{2}$$

Limits at infinity:

- Positive Infinity:

$$\lim_{x\to\infty} f(x) = \log(\infty - 1) = \infty$$

Is there an oblique asymptote?
Notice how we can rewrite the logarithm:

$$f(x) = \log\left[e^{2x}\left(1 - \frac{1}{e^{2x}}\right)\right] = \log\left(e^{2x}\right) + \log\left(1 - e^{-2x}\right) = 2x + \log\left(1 - e^{-2x}\right)$$

so we have an oblique asymptote:

$$m = \lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{f(x)}{x} = \lim_{x\to\infty} 2 + \frac{\log\left(1 - e^{-2x}\right)}{x} = 2 + \frac{\log(1^-)}{+\infty} = 2 + \frac{0^-}{+\infty} = 2$$

Alternatively the **squeeze theorem** can be used:

$$m = \lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{f(x)}{x} = \lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{\log(e^{2x} - 1)}{x}$$

Now find the bounds:

- Upper bound: $e^{2x} - 1 < e^{2x} \to \log(e^{2x} - 1) < 2x$
- Lower bound: $e^{2x} - 1 > \frac{e^{2x}}{2} \to \log(e^{2x} - 1) > 2x - \log(2)$ valid for large x ($x > 1$)
  Now divide by $x > 0$

$$2 - \frac{\log(2)}{x} \leq \frac{\log(e^{2x} - 1)}{x} \leq 2$$

Take the limit:

$$2 \leq \lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{f(x)}{x} \leq 2$$

The interception is:

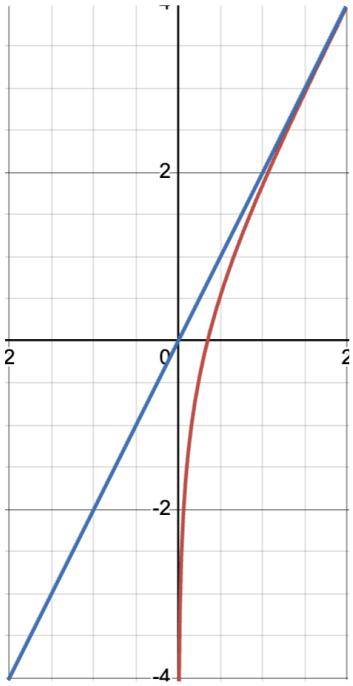
$$\begin{aligned} q = \lim_{x\to\infty} f(x) - 2x &= +\infty - \infty \quad \text{indeterminate form!} \\ &= 2x + \log(1 - e^{-2x}) - 2x \\ &= \log(1 - e^{-2x}) = 0^- \end{aligned}$$

- Negative Infinity excluded by domain.

Limits at accumulation points:
Here we just need to check for 0^+ as 0^- is not in the domain!

- At 0^+:

$$\lim_{x\to 0^+} f(x) = \log(1^+ - 1) = \log(0^+) = -\infty$$



Asymptote in Blue

5) Exponential (Harder)

Determine the natural domain, the sign, and the limits at infinity (if any) and at the accumulation points of the domain.

$$f(x) = e^{\frac{x^2-4}{x-1}}$$

Domain:

$$D = \{x - 1 \neq 0\} = \mathbb{R} \setminus \{1\} = (-\infty, 1) \cup (1, +\infty)$$

Sign:
Since the exponential function satisfies $e^t > 0$ for all $t \in \mathbb{R}$:

$$f(x) > 0 \quad \forall x \in D$$

We don't have any zeros.

Limits at infinity:

- Positive Infinity:

$$\lim_{x\to+\infty} f(x) = e^{+\infty} = +\infty$$

Is there an oblique asymptote?
Check the slope m:

$$m = \lim_{x\to+\infty} \frac{f(x)}{x} = \lim_{x\to+\infty} \frac{e^{\frac{x^2-4}{x-1}}}{x}$$

Notice by polynomial division that $\frac{x^2-4}{x-1} = x + 1 - \frac{3}{x-1}$, so:

$$\frac{f(x)}{x} = \frac{e^{x+1} \cdot e^{-\frac{3}{x-1}}}{x} = e \cdot e^{-\frac{3}{x-1}} \cdot \frac{e^x}{x}$$

Therefore

$$\lim_{x \to \infty} \frac{f(x)}{x} = e \cdot e^0 \cdot \infty = \infty$$

There is no horizontal or oblique asymptote as $x \to +\infty$.

- Negative Infinity:

$$\lim_{x \to -\infty} f(x) = e^{-\infty} = 0^+$$

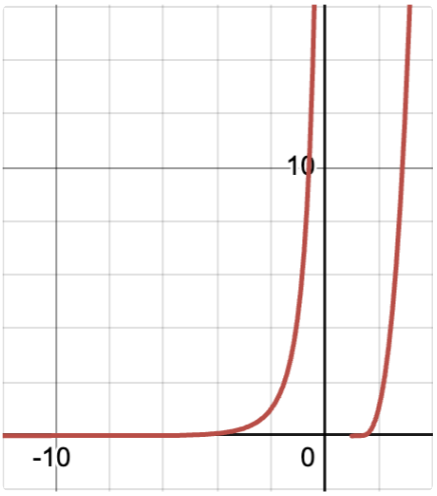
We have a horizontal asymptote at $y = 0$ as $x \to -\infty$.

Limits at accumulation points:

- At 1

$$\lim_{x \to 1^+} \frac{x^2-4}{x-1} = \frac{-3}{0^+} = -\infty \implies \lim_{x \to 1^+} f(x) = e^{-\infty} = 0^+$$

$$\lim_{x \to 1^-} \frac{x^2-4}{x-1} = \frac{-3}{0^-} = +\infty \implies \lim_{x \to 1^-} f(x) = e^{+\infty} = +\infty$$



Graph

6) Sqrt (Hardest)

Determine the natural domain, the sign, and the limits at infinity (if any) and at the accumulation points of the domain.

$$f(x) = 5x + 2 - \sqrt{25x^2 + 12x}$$

Domain:
The roots are $x = -\frac{12}{25}$ and $x = 0$. Taking the external intervals:

$$D = \left\{25x^2 + 12x \geq 0\right\} = \left(-\infty, -\frac{12}{25}\right] \cup [0, +\infty)$$

Sign:

$$f(x) > 0 \iff \sqrt{25x^2 + 12x} < 5x + 2$$

As seen in first class (case $\sqrt{A(x)} < B(x)$) we have:

$$\begin{cases} A(x) \geq 0 \\ B(x) > 0 \\ A(x) < [B(x)]^2 \end{cases} \iff \begin{cases} x \in \left(-\infty, -\frac{12}{25}\right] \cup [0, +\infty) \\ 5x + 2 > 0 \implies x > -\frac{2}{5} \\ 25x^2 + 12x < 25x^2 + 20x + 4 \implies x > -\frac{1}{2} \end{cases}$$

Then:

$$f(x) > 0 \iff x \in [0, +\infty)$$

Limits at infinity:

- Positive Infinity:

$$\lim_{x \to +\infty} f(x) = (+\infty) - (+\infty) \quad \text{indeterminate form!}$$

Rationalize the expression:
To rationalize the idea is as follows:

$$a \pm \sqrt{b} = (a \pm \sqrt{b}) \frac{a \mp \sqrt{b}}{a \mp \sqrt{b}} = \frac{a^2 - b}{a \mp \sqrt{b}}$$

Apply it directly

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) &= 2 + (\underbrace{5x}_{a} - \sqrt{\underbrace{25x^2 + 12x}_{b}}) \\ &= 2 + \frac{(5x - \sqrt{25x^2 + 12x})(5x + \sqrt{25x^2 + 12x})}{5x + \sqrt{25x^2 + 12x}} \\ &= 2 + \frac{25x^2 - (25x^2 + 12x)}{5x + \sqrt{25x^2 + 12x}} \qquad \$\$For \$x > 0\$, extract \$|x| = x\$: \$\$ \lim_{x \to +\infty} f(x) = \lim_{x \to +\infty} 2 - \\ &= 2 - \frac{12x}{5x + \sqrt{25x^2 + 12x}} \\ &= 2 - \frac{12x}{5x + |x|\sqrt{25 + \frac{12}{x}}} \end{aligned}$$

- Negative Infinity:

$$\lim_{x \to -\infty} f(x) = 5(-\infty) + 2 - \sqrt{+\infty} = -\infty - \infty = -\infty$$

This is not indeterminate.
Is there an oblique asymptote?
Find the slope m (recall now since $x < 0 \to |x| = -x$):

$$m = \lim_{x \to -\infty} \frac{f(x)}{x} = \lim_{x \to -\infty} \left(5 + \frac{2}{x} - \frac{\sqrt{25x^2 + 12x}}{x}\right) = 5 + \lim_{x \to -\infty} \frac{x\sqrt{25 + \frac{12}{x}}}{x} = 10$$

Now find the intercept q:

$$q = \lim_{x \to -\infty} [f(x) - 10x] = \lim_{x \to -\infty} [2 - 5x - \sqrt{25x^2 + 12x}] = 2 - \lim_{x \to -\infty} \left(5x + \sqrt{25x^2 + 12x}\right)$$

This is an indeterminate form $(-\infty) + (+\infty)$.
Rationalize

$$\begin{aligned}
5x+\sqrt{25x^2+12x} &= \left(5x+\sqrt{25x^2+12x}\right)\frac{5x-\sqrt{25x^2+12x}}{5x-\sqrt{25x^2+12x}} \\
&= \frac{25x^2-\left(25x^2+12x\right)}{5x-\sqrt{25x^2+12x}} \\
&= \frac{-12x}{5x-\sqrt{25x^2+12x}} \\
&= \frac{-12x}{5x-|x|\sqrt{25+\frac{12}{x}}}
\end{aligned}$$

Then

$$q = 2+\lim_{x\to-\infty}\frac{12x}{5x-|x|\sqrt{25+\frac{12}{x}}} = 2+\lim_{x\to-\infty}\frac{12}{5+\sqrt{25+\frac{12}{x}}} = 2+\frac{12}{10} = \frac{16}{5}$$

We have an oblique asymptote:

$$y = 10x+\frac{16}{5} \quad \text{as } x\to-\infty$$

Limits at accumulation points:

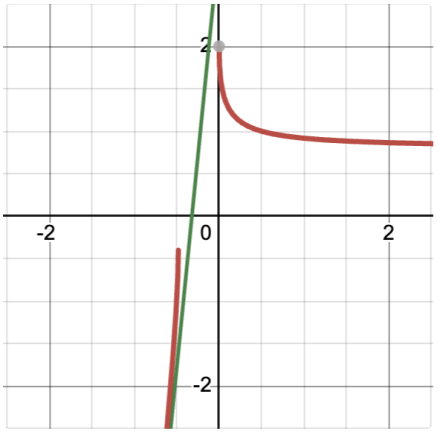
- At 0 (only 0^+ due to domain):

$$\lim_{x\to0^+} f(x) = f(0) = 5(0)+2-0 = 2$$

- At $-\frac{12}{25}$ (only $\left(-\frac{12}{25}\right)^-$ due to domain):

$$\lim_{x\to\left(-\frac{12}{25}\right)^-} f(x) = f\left(-\frac{12}{25}\right) = 5\left(-\frac{12}{25}\right)+2-0 = -\frac{12}{5}+2 = -\frac{2}{5}$$

There are no vertical asymptotes.



Asymptote in Green

4.2) Taylor Expansion

A **Taylor expansion** takes a smooth function $f(x)$ near a specific point x_0 and replaces it with a **polynomial clone** $P_n(x)$ of degree n, plus a tiny error term (the remainder). This is useful as it transforms complicated functions in a simple polynomial function, which are easier to manipulate

$$f(x) = \sum_{k=0}^{n}\frac{f^{(k)}(x_0)}{k!}(x-x_0)^k + o\big((x-x_0)^n\big) \quad \text{as } x\to x_0$$

But we will mostly limit our study cases at $x\to0$ (for now)

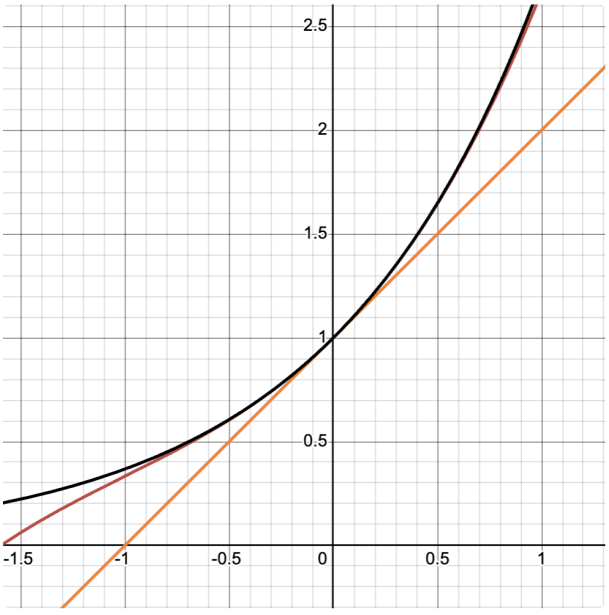
$$f(x) = \sum_{k=0}^{n} \frac{f^{(k)}(0)}{k!} x^k + o(x^n) \quad \text{as } x \to 0$$

For now, since derivatives are not yet introduced, all the expansions will be provided.

Consider $f(x) = e^x$ at $x_0 = 0$. It's expansion is (up to order 3) $e^x = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2} + \frac{x^3}{6} + o(x^3)$.
Now let's consider how well the various orders approximate $e^{0.5} = 1.64872$

Order n	$P_n(x)$	$P_n(0.5)$	$e^{0.5} - P_n(0.5)$
0	1	1	0.649
1	$1 + x$	1.5	0.149
2	$1 + x + \frac{1}{2}x^2$	1.625	0.024
3	$1 + x + \frac{1}{2}x^2 + \frac{1}{6}x^3$	1.64583	0.0029

at order 3 it is already 99.8% accurate!



f(x) in black, 1st order expansion in orange, 3rd order expansion in red

4.2.1) Little-*o* Notation

Little o is the correction term. This encapsulates the difference of $f(x)$ and $P_n(x)$.

Definition 1 (Little-*o*)**.**

Given two functions $f(x)$ and $g(x)$ near x_0 (with $g(x) \neq 0$ in a punctured neighborhood of x_0), we say that $f(x)$ **is "little-o" of** $g(x)$ **as** $x \to x_0$, written $f(x) = o\big(g(x)\big)$, if:

$$\lim_{x \to x_0} \frac{f(x)}{g(x)} = 0$$

This is, in the Taylor expansion writing $o(x^n)$ means that all the next order terms go to zero faster than x^n and can be ignored.

For now let's just focus on $x \to 0$

Intuitively, little-*o*, refers to any function that shrinks faster then the specified function. Therefore we can say that $f(x) = o(g(x))$ is an abuse of notation as it should be $f(x) \in o(g(x))$ since $o(g(x))$ is a set that refers to all functions $h(x)$ where $h(x) \ll g(x)$

For example consider powers. As $x \to 0$ we have

$$x^n \ll x^m \quad \text{for } n > m$$

Therefore we can say:

- $x^3 = o(x^2)$ since $\lim_{x\to 0} x^3/x^2 = \lim_{x\to 0} x = 0$
- But not $x^2 = o(x^3)$ since $\lim_{x\to 0} x^2/x^3 = \lim_{x\to 0} 1/x = \pm\infty$

Theorem 2 (Little-*o* Propeeties)**.**

Here are some properties of little-o. Let $n > 0$:

- *Constant Multiplication:*

$$c \cdot o(x^n) = o(x^n) \text{ for any constant } c \neq 0 \qquad \text{The error has the same order}$$

- *Same Order Addition/subtraction:*

$$o(x^n) \pm o(x^n) = o(x^n) \quad \text{Important: } o(x^n) - o(x^n) \text{ is NOT } =0$$

- *Different order addition (Absorption):*

$$o(x^n) + o(x^m) = o(x^{\min(n,m)}) \quad \text{Ex: } o(x^2) + o(x^4) = o(x^2) \text{ since } x^4 \in o(x^2)$$

- *Absorbing Powers:*

$$c \cdot x^m + o(x^n) = o(x^n) \text{ if } m > n \quad \text{Ex: } 5x^7 + o(x^3) = o(x^3) \text{ since } x^7 \in o(x^3)$$

- *Multiplication by powers:*

$$x^m \cdot o(x^n) = o(x^{m+n}) \quad \text{Ex: } x^5 \cdot o(x^3) = o(x^8)$$

- *Product of two Little-o's:*

$$o(x^m) \cdot o(x^n) = o(x^{m+n}) \quad \text{Ex: } o(x^2) \cdot o(x^3) = o(x^5)$$

- *Powers of Little-o:*

$$[o(x^n)]^k = o(x^{n\cdot k}) \quad \text{Ex: } [o(x^2)]^3 = o(x^6)$$

Proofs (very quick):

1. Constant Multiplication: $c \cdot o(x^n) = o(x^n)$ $(c \neq 0)$
   Let $f(x) \in o(x^n)$, consider $g(x) = c \cdot f(x)$:

$$\lim_{x\to 0} \frac{g(x)}{x^n} = \lim_{x\to 0} \frac{c \cdot f(x)}{x^n} = c \cdot \lim_{x\to 0} \frac{f(x)}{x^n} = c \cdot 0 = 0$$

   Therefore, $c \cdot f(x) \in o(x^n)$.
2. Same-Order Addition / Subtraction: $o(x^n) \pm o(x^n) = o(x^n)$
   Let $f(x), g(x) \in o(x^n)$, consider $h(x) = f(x) \pm g(x)$:

$$\lim_{x\to 0} \frac{h(x)}{x^n} = \lim_{x\to 0} \left(\frac{f(x)}{x^n} \pm \frac{g(x)}{x^n} \right) = \lim_{x\to 0} \frac{f(x)}{x^n} \pm \lim_{x\to 0} \frac{g(x)}{x^n} = 0 \pm 0 = 0$$

   Hence, $f(x) \pm g(x) \in o(x^n)$.

3. Different-Order Addition (Absorption): $o(x^n) + o(x^m) = o(x^{\min(n,m)})$
   Assume (without loss of generality) that $n \leq m$, so $\min(n, m) = n$.
   Let $f(x) \in o(x^n)$ and $g(x) \in o(x^m)$.
   Examine the quotient with x^n:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{f(x) + g(x)}{x^n} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{f(x)}{x^n} + \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{g(x)}{x^n}$$

   By assumption, $\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{f(x)}{x^n} = 0$.
   For $g(x)$, rewrite the fraction by factoring out x^{m-n} (where $m - n \geq 0$):

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{g(x)}{x^n} = \lim_{x \to 0} \left(\frac{g(x)}{x^m} \cdot x^{m-n} \right) = \left(\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{g(x)}{x^m} \right) \cdot \left(\lim_{x \to 0} x^{m-n} \right) = 0 \cdot \lim_{x \to 0} x^{m-n} = 0$$

   Thus:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{f(x) + g(x)}{x^n} = 0 + 0 = 0 \implies f(x) + g(x) \in o(x^n)$$

4. Absorbing Powers: $c \cdot x^m + o(x^n) = o(x^n)$ if $m > n$
   Let $f(x) \in o(x^n)$ and $h(x) = cx^m + f(x)$ with $m > n$.
   Compute the limit:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{h(x)}{x^n} = \lim_{x \to 0} \left(\frac{cx^m}{x^n} + \frac{f(x)}{x^n} \right) = \lim_{x \to 0} \left(cx^{m-n} + \frac{f(x)}{x^n} \right)$$

   Because $m - n > 0$:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} cx^{m-n} = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{f(x)}{x^n} = 0$$

   Adding the limits yields $0 + 0 = 0$, confirming $cx^m + f(x) \in o(x^n)$.
5. Multiplication by Powers: $x^m \cdot o(x^n) = o(x^{m+n})$
   Let $f(x) \in o(x^n)$. Consider $g(x) = x^m \cdot f(x)$:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{g(x)}{x^{m+n}} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{x^m \cdot f(x)}{x^m \cdot x^n} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{f(x)}{x^n} = 0$$

   Hence, $x^m \cdot f(x) \in o(x^{m+n})$.
6. Product of Two Little-o's: $o(x^m) \cdot o(x^n) = o(x^{m+n})$
   Let $f(x) \in o(x^m)$ and $g(x) \in o(x^n)$. Consider $h(x) = f(x) \cdot g(x)$:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{h(x)}{x^{m+n}} = \lim_{x \to 0} \left(\frac{f(x)}{x^m} \cdot \frac{g(x)}{x^n} \right) = \left(\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{f(x)}{x^m} \right) \cdot \left(\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{g(x)}{x^n} \right) = 0 \cdot 0 = 0$$

   Hence, $f(x) \cdot g(x) \in o(x^{m+n})$.
7. Powers of Little-o: $[o(x^n)]^k = o(x^{n \cdot k})$ ($k \in \mathbb{N}_{\geq 1}$)
   Let $f(x) \in o(x^n)$. Consider $g(x) = [f(x)]^k$:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{g(x)}{x^{n \cdot k}} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{[f(x)]^k}{(x^n)^k} = \lim_{x \to 0} \left(\frac{f(x)}{x^n} \right)^k$$

   By the continuous mapping theorem (or the product rule applied k times):

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \left(\frac{f(x)}{x^n} \right)^k = \left(\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{f(x)}{x^n} \right)^k = 0^k = 0$$

   Thus, $[f(x)]^k \in o(x^{n \cdot k})$.

4.3) Exercises

1) Little-*o* Warm Up Exercise:

Simplify the following expression as $x \to 0$:

$$E(x) = \big(x + 2x^2 + o(x^2)\big) - \big(x - x^2 + 4x^3 + o(x^3)\big)$$

Do the basic algebraic simplifications:

$$E(x) = 3x^2 - 4x^3 + o(x^2) - o(x^3)$$

Since $o(x^2) + o(x^3) = o(x^2)$ we have

$$E(x) = 3x^2 - 4x^3 + o(x^2)$$

But notice that now $4x^3 \in o(x^2)$ and thus

$$E(x) = 3x^2 + o(x^2)$$

2) Classic Cancellation Limit

Compute the limit:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sin(x) - x}{x^3}$$

Recall the expansion for sin:

$$\sin(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{x^{2n+1}}{(2n+1)!} = x - \frac{x^3}{3!} + \frac{x^5}{5!} - \cdots$$

This cannot be computed via the notable limit since:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sin(x) - x}{x^3} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sin(x)}{x^3} - \frac{1}{x^2} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sin(x)}{x} \cdot \frac{1}{x^2} - \frac{1}{x^2}$$

Where it is known that $\lim_{x \to 0} \sin(x)/x = 1$ therefore:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sin(x)}{x} \cdot \frac{1}{x^2} - \frac{1}{x^2} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{1}{x^2} - \frac{1}{x^2} = 0$$

But the last step is illegal, as the limit cannot be evaluated partially (that is we cannot simplify out $\sin(x)/x$ but keep $1/x^2$)

Try with order 1 expansion:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sin(x) - x}{x^3} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{x + o(x) - x}{x^3} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{o(x)}{x^3}$$

but since $o(x)/x^3 = x^{-3}o(x) = o(x^{-2})$ we cannot determine it.

Since the denominator is of order 3, we expand until this order:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{x - \frac{x^3}{6} + o(x^3) - x}{x^3} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{-\frac{x^3}{6} + o(x^3)}{x^3} = \lim_{x \to 0} -\frac{1}{6} - \frac{o(x^3)}{x^3} = -\frac{1}{6} - 0 = -\frac{1}{6}$$

since $o(x^3)/x^3 = x^{-3}o(x^3) = o(1) \to 0$ as $x \to 0$ and more in general $\lim_{x \to 0} o(x^n)/x^m = 0$ if $n \geq m$.

3) Two Expansions:

Compute the limit:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{e^x - \cos(x) - x}{x^2}$$

Recall both expansions:

$$e^x = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^n}{n!} = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^3}{3!} + \cdots$$
$$\cos(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{x^{2n}}{(2n)!} = 1 - \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^4}{4!} - \cdots$$

Apply them until order 2

$$\begin{aligned} e^x - \cos(x) - x &= \left(1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2} + o(x^2)\right) - \left(1 - \frac{x^2}{2} + o(x^2)\right) - x \\ &= 1 - 1 + x - x + \frac{x^2}{2} + \frac{x^2}{2} + o(x^2) + o(x^2) \\ &= x^2 + o(x^2) \end{aligned}$$

Then the limit becomes:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{e^x - \cos(x) - x}{x^2} = \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{x^2 + o(x^2)}{x^2} = 1 + 0 = 1$$

4) Substitution

Find the Taylor expansion of order 4 at $x_0 = 0$ for $g(x) = e^{-x^2}$ and use it to compute:

$$\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{e^{-x^2} - \cos(x)}{x^4}$$

Recall both expansions:

$$e^x = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^n}{n!} = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^3}{3!} + \cdots$$
$$\cos(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{x^{2n}}{(2n)!} = 1 - \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^4}{4!} - \cdots$$

We need to expand up to order 4. For cosine it is known, but e^{-x^2} doesn't have the basic formula.
Notice that with $t = -x^2$ we can expand e^t up to order 2 (since $o(t^2) \to o(x^4)$). This can be done since both tend to 0 as $x \to 0$

$$e^t = 1 + t + \frac{t^2}{2} + o(t^2) \to e^{-x^2} = 1 - x^2 + \frac{x^4}{2} + o(x^4)$$

Now expand the limit:

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{e^{-x^2} - \cos(x)}{x^4} &= \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{1 - x^2 + \frac{x^4}{2} + o(x^4) - 1 + \frac{x^2}{2} - \frac{x^4}{24} - o(x^4)}{x^4} \\ &= \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{-\frac{1}{2}x^2 + \frac{11}{24}x^4 + o(x^4)}{x^4} \\ &= \lim_{x \to 0} \frac{11}{24} - \frac{1}{2x^2} + \frac{o(x^4)}{x^4} \\ &= \frac{11}{24} - \infty + 0 \\ &= -\infty \end{aligned}$$

5) Exam 12.09.22

Compute the limit $\forall \alpha \in \mathbb{R}$:

$$\lim_{x \to 0^+} \frac{\sin x - \alpha x + \frac{1}{6}\alpha x^3}{\arctan(x^2 + 4x^3)}$$

First recall the standard expansions:

$$\sin(x) = x - \frac{x^3}{6} + \frac{x^5}{120} + o(x^5)$$
$$\arctan(x) = x - \frac{x^3}{3} + \frac{x^5}{5} + o(x^5)$$

Since the highest order degree is x^3 we expand at order 3:
Numerator:

$$\sin x - \alpha x + \frac{\alpha}{6}x^3 = x - \frac{x^3}{6} - \alpha x + \frac{\alpha}{6}x^3 + o(x^3) = (1-\alpha)x + \frac{\alpha - 1}{6}x^3 + o(x^3)$$

Denominator:
Use the substitution $t = x^2 + 4x^3$ (again since both t and x tend to 0 as they go to 0^+) and expand only until first order since $o(t) = o(x^2 + 4x^3) = o(x^3)$

$$\arctan t = t + o(t) = x^2 + 4x^3 + o(x^3)$$

Now rewrite the entire limit:

$$\lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{\sin x - \alpha x + \frac{1}{6}\alpha x^3}{\arctan(x^2 + 4x^3)} = \lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{(1-\alpha)x + \frac{\alpha-1}{6}x^3 + o(x^3)}{x^2 + 4x^3 + o(x^3)}$$

- Case $\alpha = 1$ (since obviously simplifies a lot)

$$\begin{aligned}\lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{o(x^3)}{x^2 + 4x^3 + o(x^3)} &= \lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{o(x^3)}{x^2(1 + 4x + \frac{o(x^3)}{x^2})} \\ &= \lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{o(x^3)}{x^2} \cdot \frac{1}{1 + 4x + \frac{o(x^3)}{x^2}} \\ &= 0 \cdot \frac{1}{1+0+0} = 0\end{aligned}$$

- Case $\alpha \neq 1$
  Now analyze the three parts of the limit:

$$\lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{(1-\alpha)x}{x^2 + 4x^3 + o(x^3)} = \lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{(1-\alpha)}{x + 4x^2 + o(x^2)} = \frac{\text{constant}}{0^+ + 0^+ + 0^+} = \begin{cases}\infty & \text{if } \alpha < 1 \\ -\infty & \text{if } \alpha > 1\end{cases}$$
$$\lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{\frac{\alpha-1}{6}x^3}{x^2 + 4x^3 + o(x^3)} = \lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{\frac{\alpha-1}{6}x}{1 + 4x + o(x)} = \frac{\text{constant} \cdot 0^+}{1 + 0^+ + 0^+} = 0^+$$
$$\lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{o(x^3)}{x^2 + 4x^3 + o(x^3)} = 0$$

So the final result is

$$\lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{\sin(x) - \alpha x + \frac{1}{6}\alpha x^3}{\arctan(x^2 + 4x^3)} = \begin{cases}+\infty & \text{if } \alpha < 1 \\ 0 & \text{if } \alpha = 1 \\ -\infty & \text{if } \alpha > 1\end{cases}$$

Alternatively notice it can be rewritten as

$$\lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{x\left[(1-\alpha) + \frac{\alpha-1}{6}x^2 + \frac{o(x^3)}{x}\right]}{x\left[x + 4x^2 + \frac{o(x^3)}{x}\right]} = \lim_{x\to 0^+} \frac{1 - \alpha + \frac{\alpha-1}{6}x^2 + o(x^2)}{x + 4x^2 + o(x^2)}$$

Which can be easily computed.

5) Symbols

- $\Longrightarrow$: implies, sufficient condition ($P \implies Q$ means P is sufficient for Q, Q is necessary for P).
- $\Longleftarrow$: implied by, necessary condition
- $\Longleftrightarrow$: necessary + sufficient, if and only if "iff"
- $\emptyset$: empty set
- $\mathbb{N}$: natural numbers; $\{0, 1, 2, \dots\}$
- $\mathbb{Z}$: integer numbers; $\{\dots, -2, -1, 0, 1, 2, \dots\}$
- $\mathbb{Q}$: rational numbers; $\left\{\frac{m}{n}\ m, n \in \mathbb{Z}, n \neq 0\right\}$
- $\mathbb{R}$: real numbers
- $\mathbb{C}$: complex numbers
- $\cup$: Union; or
- $\cap$: Intersection; and
- $\exists$: there exists